Northgate Community Food Bank AI use policy

Draft for board review · Effective when the board approves it · Owner: Executive director, until the board names an owner · Next review: in 12 months

Why we have this policy. We want AI to take routine writing off our plate. We must protect SNAP applicants, donors and volunteers, and keep a real person for anyone who needs help.

Who it covers. Staff, contractors and board members. Whether volunteers may use AI is still open for the board.

TOOLS WE USE

- **Gemini (in Google Workspace):** Drafting and editing only; no protected information.
- **New tools, add-ons and AI features.** Ken (IT) approves new tools, plugins, AI agents and AI features in existing software, after checking what data they see and whether the vendor trains on it.
- **Accounts.** Use your work Google account and turn off vendor training on what you type.

WHAT YOU CAN USE AI FOR

- **Everyone, now.** Staff may use Gemini in a work account for work with no information about a real person. Volunteer use waits for the board's decision.
- Draft newsletters and social posts.
- Write general volunteer thank-yous; add names yourself afterward.
- Draft grant boilerplate about our work.

NEEDS APPROVAL FIRST

- Donor information in an AI tool — *Marcus (CEO)*
- Reports to funders or Feeding America — *Your manager*
- Recall notices or allergen information — *Your manager*
- Anything using a corporate partner's logo or brand — *Your manager*

OFF LIMITS

- **Never put this into an AI tool** unless the tool is approved for it above: SNAP applicants' Social Security numbers, income, household members and immigration documents (state human services agreement); donor names and giving records in Salesforce; volunteer names, phone numbers, emergency contacts and court-ordered case details; mobile pantry sign-up names and zip codes; passwords and logins.
- No SNAP application information goes into any AI tool.
- No AI answers SNAP eligibility questions. A person answers the SNAP line.
- No AI images of hungry people. Our photos are real, with consent forms.

CHECK EVERYTHING BEFORE IT GOES OUT

- Whoever sends AI-assisted work owns it. Check facts, names, numbers and tone first.
- Pounds and people served come from the inventory system, never an AI draft.
- Check recall and allergen details against the original notice.

DECISIONS ABOUT PEOPLE

- AI never decides who gets help, benefits or a volunteer role. Trained people decide.

BEING OPEN ABOUT AI

- We follow the AI clause in our corporate partner's agreement.
- If a funder or partner asks about our AI use, we answer honestly.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Tell your manager and Ken the same day. Reporting a mistake is expected, never punished.

WHO OWNS THIS POLICY

- The executive director owns this policy until the board names someone; Ken approves tools.
- The board's executive committee approves changes. We review it in 12 months.

OPEN QUESTIONS FOR THE BOARD

- Do we approve or stop staff's personal ChatGPT and Claude use, and will we pay for any AI accounts next year?
- Should AI reminder texts in the volunteer scheduling software stay on, and do we tell people when AI helped write what they get?
- May volunteers, such as group leaders writing shift notes, use AI?

Sample policy for an invented organization, drafted by Fulton Ring from a mock 30-minute call. Not legal advice; not reviewed by a real nonprofit.